The Sage Programming Language

A Complete Guide to Systems Programming with Sage

SageLang Project

April 2026

Contents

1 Part I: Language Fundamentals **5**

2 Introduction **6**
2.1 Key Features 6
2.2 Quick Start 6

3 Variables and Types **8**
3.1 Variable Declaration 8
3.2 Built-in Types 8
3.3 Type Checking 9
3.4 Type Conversion 9

4 Operators **10**
4.1 Arithmetic Operators 10
4.2 Comparison Operators 10
4.3 Logical Operators 11
4.4 Bitwise Operators 11
4.5 String Concatenation 11

5 Control Flow **12**
5.1 If / Elif / Else 12
5.2 While Loops 13
5.3 For Loops 13
5.4 Break and Continue 13
5.5 Match / Case 14

6 Functions **15**
6.1 Basic Functions 15
6.2 Return Values 15
6.3 Default Parameters 15
6.4 Recursion 16
6.5 Closures 16
6.5.1 Stateful Closures 16
6.6 First-Class Functions 17

7 Strings **18**
7.1 String Basics 18

7.2 Escape Sequences . . . 18
7.3 String Functions . . . 19
7.4 String Searching . . . 19
7.5 Character Conversions . . . 19

8 Data Structures 20
8.1 Arrays . . . 20
8.2 Dictionaries . . . 21
8.3 Tuples . . . 21

9 Part II: Advanced Language Features 22

10 Object-Oriented Programming 23
10.1 Classes . . . 23
10.2 Inheritance . . . 23
10.3 Deep Inheritance . . . 24
10.4 Arrow Operator . . . 25

11 Structs, Enums, and Traits 26
11.1 Structs . . . 26
11.2 Enums . . . 26
11.3 Traits . . . 27

12 Exception Handling 28
12.1 Basic Try/Catch . . . 28
12.2 Try/Catch/Finally . . . 28
12.3 Raising Exceptions . . . 28
12.4 Nested Exception Handling . . . 29
12.5 Custom Exception Objects . . . 29

13 Generators and Iterators 30
13.1 Generator Functions . . . 30
13.2 Yielding Values . . . 30

14 Async and Concurrency 32
14.1 Async Procedures . . . 32
14.2 Threads . . . 32
14.3 Thread Sleep . . . 33

15 Pattern Matching 34
15.1 Basic Matching . . . 34
15.2 Guards . . . 34
15.3 Matching Strings . . . 35

16 Defer Statements 36

17 Module System 37
17.1 Importing Modules . . . 37
17.2 Creating Modules . . . 37

17.3 Standard Library Modules . . . 38

18 Part III: Safety and Type System **39**

19 Type Annotations **40**
19.1 Parameter Types . . . 40
19.2 Optional Types . . . 40
19.3 Generic Type Parameters . . . 41

20 The Safety System **42**
20.1 Safety Modes . . . 42
20.2 Ownership and Move Semantics . . . 42
20.3 Borrow Checker . . . 42
20.4 Lifetimes . . . 43
20.5 Option Types . . . 43
20.6 Fearless Concurrency: Send and Sync . . . 43
20.7 Unsafe Blocks . . . 44
20.8 Running the Safety Analyzer . . . 44

21 Part IV: Standard Library **45**

22 Built-in Modules **46**
22.1 Math Module . . . 46
22.2 IO Module . . . 47
22.3 String Module . . . 47
22.4 Sys Module . . . 48
22.5 Thread Module . . . 49

23 Collection Libraries **50**
23.1 Arrays Module . . . 50
23.2 Strings Module . . . 50
23.3 Dicts Module . . . 51
23.4 Iterator Module . . . 51
23.5 Stats Module . . . 51
23.6 Assert Module . . . 52

24 JSON Module **53**

25 Safety Library **54**

26 Part V: Compilation and Backends **55**

27 Compilation Backends **56**
27.1 C Backend . . . 56
27.2 LLVM Backend . . . 56
27.3 Native Assembly Backend . . . 56
27.4 Optimization Levels . . . 57
27.5 Debug Info . . . 57

28 Bare-Metal and OS Development **58**
28.1 Bare-Metal Compilation . . . 58
28.2 Target Architectures . . . 58
28.3 Boot and Kernel Libraries . . . 58
28.4 QEMU Integration . . . 59

29 Part VI: Tooling **60**

30 Developer Tools **61**
30.1 REPL . . . 61
30.2 Formatter . . . 61
30.3 Linter . . . 61
30.4 Type Checker . . . 62
30.5 Safety Analyzer . . . 62
30.6 Language Server (LSP) . . . 62

31 Build System **63**
31.1 Makefile Targets . . . 63
31.2 Version . . . 63

32 Part VII: Appendices **64**

33 Appendix A: Built-in Functions **65**
33.1 Core Functions . . . 65
33.2 Array Functions . . . 65
33.3 String Functions . . . 66
33.4 Dictionary Functions . . . 66
33.5 Generator Functions . . . 66
33.6 GC Functions . . . 66
33.7 Path Functions . . . 66
33.8 Bytes Functions . . . 67
33.9 Memory Functions . . . 67
33.10FFI Functions . . . 67
33.11Struct Interop Functions . . . 68
33.12Assembly Functions . . . 68

34 Appendix B: CLI Reference **69**

35 Appendix C: Language Gotchas **71**
35.1 Still Relevant . . . 71
35.2 Fixed in v1.4+ . . . 71

36 Appendix D: Reserved Keywords **73**
36.1 Control Flow . . . 73
36.2 Functions and Classes . . . 73
36.3 Variables . . . 74
36.4 Values and Logic . . . 74
36.5 Exceptions . . . 74
36.6 Advanced . . . 74

Chapter 1

Part I: Language Fundamentals

Chapter 2

Introduction

Sage is a clean, indentation-based systems programming language built in C. It combines the readability of Python with the performance of compiled languages, offering multiple compilation backends, a compile-time safety system inspired by Rust, and a self-hosted compiler written in Sage itself.

2.1 Key Features

- **Python-like syntax** with indentation-based blocks and explicit `end` keywords
- **Multiple backends**: C codegen, LLVM IR, native x86-64/aarch64/rv64 assembly
- **Compile-time safety**: ownership tracking, borrow checker, lifetimes, Option types
- **Self-hosted compiler** written in Sage (lexer, parser, interpreter, codegen)
- **Rich standard library**: math, io, string, sys, thread, JSON, collections
- **Object-oriented programming** with classes, inheritance, structs, enums, and traits
- **Generators and async**: yield-based generators, async/await concurrency
- **Developer tooling**: formatter, linter, type checker, LSP server, REPL
- **Bare-metal and OS development**: Multiboot2, UEFI, QEMU integration
- **GPU programming**: Vulkan and OpenGL backends (covered in separate guides)
- **Machine learning**: neural networks, model training (covered in separate guides)
- **269+ interpreter tests**, 1567+ self-hosted tests

2.2 Quick Start

```
# Build from source
git clone https://github.com/Night-Traders-Dev/SageLang.git
cd SageLang
make

# Run a program
./sage hello.sage

# Interactive REPL
./sage
```

A minimal Sage program:

```
print "Hello, World!"
```

A slightly larger program demonstrating functions and control flow:

```
proc fizzbuzz(n):
    for i in range(1, n + 1):
        if i % 15 == 0:
            print "FizzBuzz"
        elif i % 3 == 0:
            print "Fizz"
        elif i % 5 == 0:
            print "Buzz"
        else:
            print i
        end
    end
end

fizzbuzz(20)
```

Chapter 3

Variables and Types

Sage supports `let` for variable declaration and `var` for mutable variables.

3.1 Variable Declaration

```
# Immutable binding
let name = "Alice"
let age = 30
let pi = 3.14159
let active = true
let nothing = nil

# Mutable variable
var counter = 0
counter = counter + 1
print counter    # 1
```

Variables declared with `let` cannot be reassigned. Use `var` when you need a variable whose value changes over time.

3.2 Built-in Types

Type	Example	Description
Number	`42`, `3.14`, `0xFF`, `0o755`	Integer or floating-point
String	`"hello"`	Text with escape sequences
Boolean	`true`, `false`	Logical values
Nil	`nil`	Absence of value
Array	`[1, 2, 3]`	Ordered, mutable collection
Dict	`{"a": 1}`	Key-value mapping
Tuple	`(1, "x")`	Immutable ordered pair

Sage numbers are IEEE 754 double-precision floating point. Integer values are exact up to 2^53.

Hex literals (`0xFF`) and octal literals (`0o755`) are supported as of v1.4.

3.3 Type Checking

The `type()` function returns the type of any value as a string:

```
print type(42)          # "number"
print type("hello")     # "string"
print type(true)        # "bool"
print type(nil)         # "nil"
print type([1, 2])      # "array"
print type({"a": 1})    # "dict"
print type((1, 2))      # "tuple"
```

3.4 Type Conversion

```
# Number to string
print str(42)           # "42"
print str(3.14)         # "3.14"
print str(true)         # "true"
print str(nil)          # "nil"

# String to number
print tonumber("123")   # 123
print tonumber("3.14")  # 3.14

# Truncate to integer
print int(3.7)          # 3
print int(-2.9)         # -2

# Character conversions
print chr(65)           # "A"
print ord("A")          # 65
print chr(10)           # newline character
```

Chapter 4

Operators

4.1 Arithmetic Operators

```
print 5 + 2     # 7   (addition)
print 5 - 2     # 3   (subtraction)
print 5 * 2     # 10  (multiplication)
print 5 / 2     # 2.5 (division)
print 5 % 2     # 1   (modulo, uses fmod for floats)
print -5        # -5  (negation)

# Operator precedence follows standard math rules
print 2 + 3 * 4       # 14 (not 20)
print (2 + 3) * 4     # 20
```

The `%` operator uses `fmod()` internally, so it preserves float semantics:

```
print 7.5 % 2.5    # 0
print 3.7 % 1.0    # 0.7
```

4.2 Comparison Operators

```
print 1 == 1     # true
print 1 != 2     # true
print 1 < 2      # true
print 2 > 1      # true
print 1 <= 1     # true
print 1 >= 1     # true
```

Comparison works structurally for arrays, dicts, and class instances. Two instances with the same fields and values compare as equal.

4.3 Logical Operators

```
print true and false    # false
print true or false     # true
print not true          # false
```

> **Important:** In Sage, `0` is **truthy**. Only `false` and `nil` are falsy. Use explicit comparisons: `if x == 0:` rather than `if not x:`.

4.4 Bitwise Operators

```
print 5 & 3     # 1   (AND)
print 5 | 3     # 7   (OR)
print 5 ^ 3     # 6   (XOR)
print ~5        # -6  (NOT)
print 1 << 4    # 16  (left shift)
print 16 >> 2   # 4   (right shift)
```

4.5 String Concatenation

Strings are concatenated with `+`:

```
let greeting = "Hello" + ", " + "World!"
print greeting    # Hello, World!

# Convert other types before concatenation
let msg = "Count: " + str(42)
print msg         # Count: 42
```

Chapter 5

Control Flow

5.1 If / Elif / Else

Conditional blocks use `if`, `elif`, `else`, and are terminated with `end`:

```
let x = 42

if x > 100:
    print "big"
elif x > 10:
    print "medium"
else:
    print "small"
end
```

The `elif` keyword supports unlimited branches. Sage processes them as chained if/else structures internally.

```
let grade = 85

if grade >= 90:
    print "A"
elif grade >= 80:
    print "B"
elif grade >= 70:
    print "C"
elif grade >= 60:
    print "D"
else:
    print "F"
end
```

5.2 While Loops

```
var i = 0
while i < 5:
    print i
    i = i + 1
end
```

5.3 For Loops

```
# Iterate over arrays
let fruits = ["apple", "banana", "cherry"]
for fruit in fruits:
    print fruit
end

# Range-based for loop
for i in range(5):
    print i    # 0, 1, 2, 3, 4
end

# Range with start and end
for i in range(2, 5):
    print i    # 2, 3, 4
end
```

5.4 Break and Continue

```
# Break exits the loop
var i = 0
while true:
    if i == 5:
        break
    end
    print i
    i = i + 1
end

# Continue skips to the next iteration
for x in range(10):
    if x % 2 == 0:
        continue
    end
    print x    # 1, 3, 5, 7, 9
end
```

5.5 Match / Case

Pattern matching with optional guards:

```
let color = "red"
match color:
    case "red":
        print "Stop"
    end
    case "yellow":
        print "Caution"
    end
    case "green":
        print "Go"
    end
    default:
        print "Unknown color"
    end
end
```

Match with guards using `if`:

```
let score = 85
match score:
    case score if score >= 90:
        print "Excellent"
    end
    case score if score >= 70:
        print "Good"
    end
    default:
        print "Needs improvement"
    end
end
```

Chapter 6

Functions

Functions are declared with `proc` and terminated with `end`.

6.1 Basic Functions

```
proc greet(name):
    print "Hello, " + name + "!"
end

greet("Alice")    # Hello, Alice!
```

6.2 Return Values

```
proc add(a, b):
    return a + b
end

let result = add(3, 4)
print result    # 7
```

6.3 Default Parameters

```
proc connect(host, port, ssl):
    print "Connecting to " + host + ":" + str(port)
end

proc greet_user(name, greeting):
    print greeting + ", " + name + "!"
end
```

```
greet_user("Alice", "Hello")     # Hello, Alice!
greet_user("Bob", "Hi")          # Hi, Bob!
```

6.4 Recursion

```
proc factorial(n):
    if n <= 1:
        return 1
    end
    return n * factorial(n - 1)
end

print factorial(5)     # 120

proc fibonacci(n):
    if n <= 1:
        return n
    end
    return fibonacci(n - 1) + fibonacci(n - 2)
end

print fibonacci(10)    # 55
```

6.5 Closures

Functions capture their lexical scope, enabling closures:

```
proc make_adder(n):
    proc add(x):
        return x + n
    end
    return add
end

let add5 = make_adder(5)
print add5(10)    # 15
print add5(20)    # 25
```

6.5.1 Stateful Closures

```
proc make_counter():
    var count = 0
    proc increment():
        count = count + 1
        return count
    end
```

```
    return increment
end

let counter = make_counter()
print counter()    # 1
print counter()    # 2
print counter()    # 3
```

6.6 First-Class Functions

Functions are values and can be passed as arguments:

```
proc apply(f, x):
    return f(x)
end

proc double(n):
    return n * 2
end

print apply(double, 5)    # 10

# Anonymous-style via closures
let square = proc(x):
    return x * x
end

print square(4)    # 16
```

Chapter 7

Strings

Sage strings support escape sequences and a rich set of built-in operations.

7.1 String Basics

```
let greeting = "Hello, World!"
print len(greeting)    # 13

# Character access by index
print greeting[0]      # "H"
print greeting[7]      # "W"
```

7.2 Escape Sequences

As of v1.4, Sage supports the following escape sequences in string literals:

Escape	Character
`\n`	Newline (LF)
`\t`	Tab
`\r`	Carriage return
`\\`	Backslash
`\"`	Double quote
`\'`	Single quote
`\0`	Null byte
`\a`	Bell
`\b`	Backspace
`\f`	Form feed
`\v`	Vertical tab
`\xHH`	Hex byte (e.g. `\x41` = "A")

```
print "Line one\nLine two"
print "Column1\tColumn2"
print "She said \\"hi\\""
print "Hex: \x48\x65\x6C\x6C\x6F"    # "Hello"
```

7.3 String Functions

```
# Case conversion
print upper("hello")                  # "HELLO"
print lower("HELLO")                  # "hello"

# Trimming
print strip("  hello  ")             # "hello"

# Replacement
print replace("hello", "l", "r")     # "herro"

# Splitting and joining
let parts = split("a,b,c", ",")
print parts[0]                        # "a"
print join(parts, "-")                # "a-b-c"
```

7.4 String Searching

```
print startswith("hello", "hel")       # true
print endswith("hello", "llo")         # true
print contains("hello world", "world") # true
print indexof("hello", "ll")           # 2
```

7.5 Character Conversions

```
print chr(65)     # "A"
print chr(10)     # newline
print ord("A")    # 65
print ord("z")    # 122
```

Chapter 8

Data Structures

8.1 Arrays

Arrays are ordered, mutable collections:

```
let nums = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
print nums[0]          # 1
print len(nums)        # 5

# Push and pop
push(nums, 6)
print len(nums)        # 6
let last = pop(nums)
print last             # 6

# Both push() and append() work identically
append(nums, 7)
print len(nums)        # 6

# Slicing
let sub = slice(nums, 1, 3)
print sub              # [2, 3]

# Nested arrays
let matrix = [[1, 2], [3, 4], [5, 6]]
print matrix[1][0]     # 3

# Iteration
var total = 0
for n in nums:
    total = total + n
end
print total
```

8.2 Dictionaries

Dictionaries are key-value mappings with string keys:

```
let person = {"name": "Alice", "age": 30}
print person["name"]       # "Alice"

# Assignment
person["email"] = "alice@example.com"

# Check keys
print dict_has(person, "name")     # true
print dict_has(person, "phone")    # false

# Get keys and values
let keys = dict_keys(person)
let vals = dict_values(person)

# Delete a key
dict_delete(person, "age")

# Build incrementally (no multiline dict literals)
let config = {}
config["host"] = "localhost"
config["port"] = 8080
config["ssl"] = true
```

8.3 Tuples

Tuples are immutable ordered collections:

```
let point = (3, 7)
print point[0]    # 3
print point[1]    # 7
print len(point)  # 2
```

Chapter 9

Part II: Advanced Language Features

Chapter 10

Object-Oriented Programming

10.1 Classes

Classes are defined with `class` and terminated with `end`. The `init` method serves as the constructor, and `self` refers to the current instance:

```
class Person:
    proc init(self, name, age):
        self.name = name
        self.age = age
    end

    proc greet(self):
        return "Hi, I'm " + self.name
    end
end

let p = Person("Alice", 30)
print p.name       # Alice
print p.greet()    # Hi, I'm Alice
```

10.2 Inheritance

Classes can inherit from a parent class. Use `super` to call parent methods:

```
class Animal:
    proc init(self, name):
        self.name = name
    end

    proc speak(self):
        return "..."
    end
end
```

```
class Dog(Animal):
    proc init(self, name, breed):
        super.init(self, name)
        self.breed = breed
    end

    proc speak(self):
        return "Woof!"
    end
end

let d = Dog("Rex", "German Shepherd")
print d.name       # Rex
print d.breed      # German Shepherd
print d.speak()    # Woof!
```

Note that `super` requires explicit `self` as the first argument: `super.init(self, args)`.

10.3 Deep Inheritance

```
class A:
    proc init(self, x):
        self.x = x
    end
end

class B(A):
    proc init(self, x, y):
        super.init(self, x)
        self.y = y
    end
end

class C(B):
    proc init(self, x, y, z):
        super.init(self, x, y)
        self.z = z
    end
end

let obj = C(1, 2, 3)
print obj.x    # 1
print obj.y    # 2
print obj.z    # 3
```

10.4 Arrow Operator

The `->` operator is an alias for `.`, allowing C-style member access:

```
class Vec3:
    proc init(self, x, y, z):
        self->x = x
        self->y = y
        self->z = z
    end

    proc mag_squared(self):
        return self->x * self->x + self->y * self->y + self->z * self->z
    end
end

let v = Vec3(3, 4, 0)
print v->x               # 3
print v->mag_squared()   # 25
```

Chapter 11

Structs, Enums, and Traits

11.1 Structs

Structs define data types with typed fields:

```
struct Point:
    x: Int
    y: Int
end

struct Color:
    r: Int
    g: Int
    b: Int
end
```

Struct definitions create constructor-like classes. Fields are accessed with dot notation.

11.2 Enums

Enums define a fixed set of named variants:

```
enum Direction:
    North
    South
    East
    West
end

enum Color:
    Red
    Green
    Blue
end
```

Each variant is accessible as `Direction.North`, `Color.Red`, etc.

11.3 Traits

Traits define method signatures that classes can implement:

```
trait Printable:
    proc to_string(self) -> String
end

trait Comparable:
    proc compare(self, other) -> Int
end
```

Traits provide a form of interface specification. Classes implementing a trait should provide all the methods declared in the trait.

Chapter 12

Exception Handling

Exception handling uses `try`, `catch`, `finally`, and `raise`, with blocks terminated by `end`:

12.1 Basic Try/Catch

```
try:
    let result = 10 / 0
catch e:
    print "Error: " + e
end
```

12.2 Try/Catch/Finally

The `finally` block always executes, whether or not an exception was raised:

```
try:
    print "Opening resource"
    raise "Something went wrong"
catch e:
    print "Caught: " + e
finally:
    print "Cleanup complete"
end
```

12.3 Raising Exceptions

```
proc divide(a, b):
    if b == 0:
        raise "Division by zero"
    end
    return a / b
end
```

```
try:
    print divide(10, 0)
catch e:
    print e    # Division by zero
end
```

12.4 Nested Exception Handling

```
try:
    try:
        raise "inner error"
    catch e:
        print "Inner: " + e
    end
    print "Outer continues"
catch e:
    print "Should not reach here"
end
```

12.5 Custom Exception Objects

You can raise any value as an exception, including dicts for structured errors:

```
proc validate_age(age):
    if age < 0:
        let err = {}
        err["type"] = "ValidationError"
        err["message"] = "Age cannot be negative"
        err["value"] = age
        raise err
    end
    return age
end

try:
    validate_age(-5)
catch e:
    print "Error: " + str(e)
end
```

Chapter 13

Generators and Iterators

13.1 Generator Functions

A function containing `yield` becomes a generator. Use `next()` to advance it:

```
proc count_up(start, limit):
    var i = start
    while i < limit:
        yield i
        i = i + 1
    end
end

let gen = count_up(0, 5)
print next(gen)    # 0
print next(gen)    # 1
print next(gen)    # 2
print next(gen)    # 3
print next(gen)    # 4
```

13.2 Yielding Values

`yield` suspends the function and returns a value to the caller. The function resumes from the point after `yield` when `next()` is called again:

```
proc fibonacci_gen():
    var a = 0
    var b = 1
    while true:
        yield a
        let temp = a
        a = b
        b = temp + b
    end
```

```
end

let fib = fibonacci_gen()
for i in range(10):
    print next(fib)
end
# Output: 0, 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13, 21, 34
```

Chapter 14

Async and Concurrency

14.1 Async Procedures

Sage supports `async proc` for concurrent execution. Use `await` to wait for the result:

```
async proc fetch_data(url):
    # Simulated async work
    return "data from " + url
end

let result = await fetch_data("https://example.com")
print result
```

14.2 Threads

The `thread` module provides OS-level threading with mutexes:

```
import thread

var shared = 0
let mtx = thread.mutex()

proc worker(id):
    for i in range(1000):
        thread.lock(mtx)
        shared = shared + 1
        thread.unlock(mtx)
    end
end

let t1 = thread.spawn(worker, 1)
let t2 = thread.spawn(worker, 2)
thread.join(t1)
thread.join(t2)
```

```
print shared    # 2000
```

14.3 Thread Sleep

```
import thread

print "Starting..."
thread.sleep(1.5)    # Sleep for 1.5 seconds
print "Done!"
```

Chapter 15

Pattern Matching

The `match` statement provides pattern matching with guards.

15.1 Basic Matching

```
let status = 404

match status:
    case 200:
        print "OK"
    end
    case 301:
        print "Moved"
    end
    case 404:
        print "Not Found"
    end
    case 500:
        print "Server Error"
    end
    default:
        print "Unknown status: " + str(status)
    end
end
```

15.2 Guards

Add conditions to cases with `if`:

```
let value = 42

match value:
    case value if value < 0:
```

```
        print "Negative"
    end
    case value if value == 0:
        print "Zero"
    end
    case value if value > 0 and value < 100:
        print "Small positive"
    end
    default:
        print "Large"
    end
end
```

15.3 Matching Strings

```
proc http_method(method):
    match method:
        case "GET":
            return "Retrieving resource"
        end
        case "POST":
            return "Creating resource"
        end
        case "PUT":
            return "Updating resource"
        end
        case "DELETE":
            return "Deleting resource"
        end
        default:
            return "Unknown method"
        end
    end
end

print http_method("GET")    # Retrieving resource
```

Chapter 16

Defer Statements

The `defer` statement schedules a statement to execute when the current scope exits, regardless of how it exits (normal return or exception):

```
proc process_file(path):
    let data = "opened"
    defer print "Closing file"

    print "Processing: " + path
    # ... do work ...
    return data
end

process_file("test.txt")
# Output:
#   Processing: test.txt
#   Closing file
```

Deferred statements execute in LIFO (last-in, first-out) order:

```
proc example():
    defer print "First deferred"
    defer print "Second deferred"
    defer print "Third deferred"
    print "Main body"
end

example()
# Output:
#   Main body
#   Third deferred
#   Second deferred
#   First deferred
```

Chapter 17

Module System

17.1 Importing Modules

```
# Import entire module
import math
print math.abs(-42)       # 42
print math.sqrt(16)       # 4

# Import specific items
from strings import pad_left
print pad_left("42", 5, "0")    # "00042"

# Import with alias
import arrays as arr
let nums = [1, 2, 3]

# Import with item alias
from math import sqrt as square_root
print square_root(25)    # 5
```

17.2 Creating Modules

Any `.sage` file is a module. Top-level definitions are exported automatically:

```
# mylib.sage
let VERSION = "1.0"

proc hello(name):
    return "Hello, " + name
end

proc add(a, b):
    return a + b
```

```
end
```

```
# main.sage
import mylib
print mylib.VERSION        # 1.0
print mylib.hello("World") # Hello, World
print mylib.add(2, 3)      # 5
```

17.3 Standard Library Modules

The following native modules are built into the interpreter:

Module	Description
`math`	Mathematical functions and constants
`io`	File I/O operations
`string`	String searching, manipulation
`sys`	System info, args, env, exit
`thread`	OS-level threading and mutexes

The following bundled Sage modules are in the `lib/` directory:

Module	Description
`arrays`	Functional array operations
`strings`	String formatting and transformation
`dicts`	Dictionary utilities
`iter`	Iterator combinators and generators
`stats`	Statistical functions
`utils`	General-purpose utilities
`assert`	Testing assertions
`math`	Extended math (Sage-level supplement)
`json`	Full JSON parser and serializer

Chapter 18

Part III: Safety and Type System

Chapter 19

Type Annotations

Sage supports optional type annotations on function parameters and return types.

19.1 Parameter Types

```
proc add(a: Int, b: Int) -> Int:
    return a + b
end

proc greet(name: String) -> String:
    return "Hello, " + name
end

proc is_even(n: Int) -> Bool:
    return n % 2 == 0
end
```

19.2 Optional Types

The `T?` syntax marks a type as optional (may be nil):

```
proc find_user(id: Int) -> String?:
    if id == 1:
        return "Alice"
    end
    return nil
end

let user = find_user(99)
if user != nil:
    print user
end
```

19.3 Generic Type Parameters

Type annotations support generic parameters for collections:

```
proc sum_list(nums: Array[Int]) -> Int:
    var total = 0
    for n in nums:
        total = total + n
    end
    return total
end
```

Type annotations are checked by the type checker (`sage check`) and the safety system but are not enforced at runtime by the interpreter.

Chapter 20

The Safety System

Sage v2.1.0 includes a compile-time safety system inspired by Rust. It provides ownership tracking, borrow checking, lifetime analysis, Option type enforcement, and fearless concurrency checks.

The safety system is a **static analysis pass** that runs after parsing and before code generation. It does not affect the interpreter.

20.1 Safety Modes

Mode	Flag	Description
Off	(default)	No safety checks
Annotated	`--safety`	Only check `@safe` functions
Strict	`--strict-safety`	Enforce everything globally

20.2 Ownership and Move Semantics

Variables own their data. When a value is assigned to another variable, ownership is transferred (moved), and the original variable becomes invalid:

```
# In strict safety mode:
let data = [1, 2, 3]
let other = data       # ownership moves to 'other'
# print data           # ERROR: use after move
print other            # OK: [1, 2, 3]
```

20.3 Borrow Checker

The borrow checker enforces two rules:

1. You can have **any number of immutable borrows** at the same time.
2. You can have **exactly one mutable borrow** at a time.
3. You cannot have both mutable and immutable borrows simultaneously.

```
# Immutable borrows are fine together
let x = 42
let a = x    # immutable borrow
let b = x    # immutable borrow -- OK

# Mutable borrow is exclusive
var y = 10
# Only one mutable reference at a time
```

20.4 Lifetimes

Lifetimes ensure references do not outlive the data they point to:

```
proc get_ref():
    let local = "hello"
    return local    # WARNING: reference may outlive local data
end
```

20.5 Option Types

In safe contexts, nil values must be handled explicitly using Option semantics:

```
proc find(items, target):
    for item in items:
        if item == target:
            return item    # Some(item)
        end
    end
    return nil             # None
end

let result = find([1, 2, 3], 2)
# In strict mode, must check before use:
if result != nil:
    print result
end
```

The safety library provides `Some()`, `None()`, `unwrap()`, and `map()` for working with Option types explicitly.

20.6 Fearless Concurrency: Send and Sync

The safety system tracks `Send` and `Sync` traits:

- **Send**: A type is `Send` if ownership can be transferred between threads.
- **Sync**: A type is `Sync` if it can be safely shared between threads.

In strict mode, passing a non-Send value to `thread.spawn` is an error.

20.7 Unsafe Blocks

Operations that bypass safety checks must be wrapped in `unsafe`:

```
unsafe:
    let ptr = mem_alloc(1024)
    mem_write(ptr, 0, 42)
    let val = mem_read(ptr, 0)
    mem_free(ptr)
end
```

20.8 Running the Safety Analyzer

```
# Analyze with default (annotated) mode
./sage --safety program.sage

# Analyze with strict mode
./sage --strict-safety program.sage

# Via the sage command
./sage safety program.sage
```

Chapter 21

Part IV: Standard Library

Chapter 22

Built-in Modules

22.1 Math Module

The `math` module provides trigonometric, logarithmic, and utility functions:

```
import math

# Trigonometry
print math.sin(math.pi / 2)    # 1.0
print math.cos(0)               # 1.0
print math.tan(math.pi / 4)    # ~1.0
print math.asin(1.0)           # ~1.5708
print math.acos(0.0)           # ~1.5708
print math.atan(1.0)           # ~0.7854
print math.atan2(1.0, 1.0)    # ~0.7854

# Powers and roots
print math.sqrt(16)            # 4
print math.pow(2, 10)          # 1024
print math.log(math.e)        # 1
print math.log10(1000)        # 3
print math.exp(1)             # ~2.71828

# Rounding
print math.floor(3.7)         # 3
print math.ceil(3.2)          # 4
print math.round(3.5)         # 4
print math.abs(-42)           # 42
print math.fmod(7, 3)         # 1

# Min/max/clamp
print math.min(3, 7)          # 3
print math.max(3, 7)          # 7
print math.clamp(150, 0, 100) # 100
```

```
# Checks
print math.isnan(0.0 / 0.0)   # true
print math.isinf(1.0 / 0.0)   # true

# Constants
print math.pi      # 3.14159265358979
print math.e       # 2.71828182845905
print math.tau     # 6.28318530717959
print math.inf     # Infinity
print math.nan     # NaN

# Random
print math.random()    # random float in [0, 1)
```

22.2 IO Module

The `io` module provides file system operations:

```
import io

# Read and write files
let content = io.readfile("data.txt")
io.writefile("output.txt", "Hello, World!")
io.appendfile("log.txt", "New entry\n")

# File system queries
print io.exists("data.txt")     # true/false
print io.isdir("/home")         # true
print io.filesize("data.txt")   # file size in bytes

# Binary I/O
let bytes = io.readbytes("image.png")
print len(bytes)    # number of bytes

# Directory listing
let files = io.listdir(".")
for f in files:
    print f
end

# Remove files
io.remove("temp.txt")
```

22.3 String Module

The `string` module provides advanced string operations:

```
import string

# Search
print string.find("hello world", "world")       # 6
print string.rfind("hello hello", "hello")       # 6
print string.startswith("hello", "hel")          # true
print string.endswith("hello", "llo")            # true
print string.contains("hello world", "world")    # true

# Character access
print string.char_at("hello", 1)                 # "e"
print string.ord("A")                            # 65
print string.chr(65)                             # "A"

# Manipulation
print string.repeat("ab", 3)          # "ababab"
print string.count("banana", "an")    # 2
print string.substr("hello", 1, 3)    # "ell"
print string.reverse("hello")         # "olleh"
```

22.4 Sys Module

The `sys` module provides system-level utilities:

```
import sys

# Command-line arguments
let args = sys.args()
for arg in args:
    print arg
end

# Environment
print sys.platform          # "linux", "darwin", or "windows"
print sys.version           # "2.1.0"
print sys.getenv("HOME")   # /home/user

# Timing
let start = sys.clock()
# ... do work ...
let elapsed = sys.clock() - start
print "Took " + str(elapsed) + " seconds"

# Sleep
sys.sleep(0.5)    # sleep for 0.5 seconds

# Exit
```

```
sys.exit(0)
```

22.5 Thread Module

The `thread` module provides OS-level concurrency:

```
import thread

# Spawn a thread
proc worker(id):
    print "Worker " + str(id) + " running"
end

let t = thread.spawn(worker, 1)
thread.join(t)

# Mutexes for synchronization
let mtx = thread.mutex()
thread.lock(mtx)
# ... critical section ...
thread.unlock(mtx)

# Sleep
thread.sleep(0.1)    # sleep for 100ms
```

Chapter 23

Collection Libraries

23.1 Arrays Module

```
import arrays

let nums = [5, 3, 8, 1, 9, 2]

# Functional operations
let doubled = arrays.map(nums, proc(x): return x * 2 end)
let evens = arrays.filter(nums, proc(x): return x % 2 == 0 end)
let total = arrays.reduce(nums, 0, proc(acc, x): return acc + x end)

# Search
print arrays.contains(nums, 8)      # true
print arrays.index_of(nums, 8)      # 2

# Transform
let rev = arrays.reverse(nums)
let combined = arrays.concat([1, 2], [3, 4])
```

23.2 Strings Module

```
import strings

let text = "  Hello, World!  "
print strings.compact(text)             # "Hello, World!"
print strings.pad_left("42", 5, "0")    # "00042"
print strings.pad_right("hi", 10, ".")  # "hi........"
print strings.repeat("ab", 3)           # "ababab"
print strings.surround("hello", "[", "]")   # "[hello]"
print strings.snake_case("HelloWorld")       # "hello_world"
print strings.dash_case("helloWorld")        # "hello-world"
```

```
print strings.csv(["a", "b", "c"])           # "a,b,c"
```

23.3 Dicts Module

```
import dicts

let config = {"host": "localhost", "port": 8080, "debug": false}

print dicts.size(config)                     # 3
print dicts.get_or(config, "timeout", 30)    # 30 (default)
print dicts.has_all(config, ["host", "port"]) # true

let entries = dicts.entries(config)
for e in entries:
    print str(e[0]) + " = " + str(e[1])
end
```

23.4 Iterator Module

```
import iter

# Infinite counter
for n in iter.count(0, 2):
    if n > 10:
        break
    end
    print n    # 0, 2, 4, 6, 8, 10
end

# Enumeration
let fruits = ["apple", "banana", "cherry"]
for pair in iter.enumerate_array(fruits):
    print str(pair[0]) + ": " + pair[1]
end

# Take first N
let first5 = iter.take(iter.count(0, 1), 5)
```

23.5 Stats Module

```
import stats

let scores = [85, 92, 78, 95, 88, 91, 76]
```

```
print stats.mean(scores)          # ~86.4
print stats.min_value(scores)     # 76
print stats.max_value(scores)     # 95
print stats.range_span(scores)    # 19
print stats.sum(scores)           # 605
```

23.6 Assert Module

```
import assert

let result = 2 + 2
assert.assert_equal(result, 4, "Basic addition")
assert.assert_true(result > 0, "Positive result")
assert.assert_not_nil(result, "Not nil")
assert.assert_close(3.14159, 3.14, 0.01, "Pi approximation")
```

Chapter 24

JSON Module

The `json` module is a full JSON parser and serializer written in pure Sage, ported from cJSON:

```
import json

# Parse a JSON string
let text = "{\"name\": \"Alice\", \"age\": 30}"
let data = json.cJSON_Parse(text)

# Access values
let name_item = json.cJSON_GetObjectItem(data, "name")
print json.cJSON_GetStringValue(name_item)    # Alice

let age_item = json.cJSON_GetObjectItem(data, "age")
print json.cJSON_GetNumberValue(age_item)     # 30

# Create JSON
let obj = json.cJSON_CreateObject()
json.cJSON_AddStringToObject(obj, "greeting", "hello")
json.cJSON_AddNumberToObject(obj, "count", 42)
json.cJSON_AddBoolToObject(obj, "active", true)

# Serialize to string
let output = json.cJSON_Print(obj)
print output

# Clean up
json.cJSON_Delete(data)
json.cJSON_Delete(obj)
```

The JSON module passes 88 tests and supports all JSON types: objects, arrays, strings, numbers, booleans, and null.

Chapter 25

Safety Library

The safety library provides explicit Option type operations for working with potentially-nil values:

```
# Option type constructors
let some_val = Some(42)
let no_val = None()

# Unwrap (panics if None)
let x = unwrap(some_val)    # 42

# Safe access with map
let doubled = map(some_val, proc(v): return v * 2 end)
# doubled is Some(84)

# Check before use
if some_val != nil:
    print unwrap(some_val)
end
```

When `--strict-safety` is enabled, the compiler enforces that all Option-typed values are checked before use, preventing nil-related runtime errors.

Chapter 26

Part V: Compilation and Backends

Chapter 27

Compilation Backends

Sage provides three compilation backends, each targeting different use cases.

27.1 C Backend

The C backend translates Sage to portable C code:

```
# Emit C source code
./sage --emit-c program.sage -o output.c

# Compile to binary via C (uses gcc/cc)
./sage --compile program.sage -o program

# Run the compiled binary
./program
```

The C backend is the most mature and supports the full language. The generated C code is portable and can be compiled with any C11-compliant compiler.

27.2 LLVM Backend

The LLVM backend generates LLVM IR text, then uses `clang` to compile:

```
# Emit LLVM IR
./sage --emit-llvm program.sage -o output.ll

# Compile to binary via LLVM
./sage --compile-llvm program.sage -o program
```

The LLVM backend supports classes, methods, exception handling, bitwise operators, and GPU operations. It links against `llvm_runtime.c` which provides 40+ runtime functions.

27.3 Native Assembly Backend

The native backend generates assembly directly for three architectures:

```
# Emit x86-64 assembly
./sage --emit-asm program.sage -o output.s --target x86-64

# Emit aarch64 assembly
./sage --emit-asm program.sage -o output.s --target aarch64

# Emit RISC-V 64-bit assembly
./sage --emit-asm program.sage -o output.s --target rv64

# Compile to native binary
./sage --compile-native program.sage -o program --target x86-64
```

27.4 Optimization Levels

All backends support optimization passes:

```
./sage -O0 program.sage    # No optimization
./sage -O1 program.sage    # Basic: constant folding
./sage -O2 program.sage    # Standard: + dead code elimination
./sage -O3 program.sage    # Aggressive: + function inlining
```

The optimization passes operate on the AST before code generation:

Level	Passes
`-O0`	None
`-O1`	Constant folding
`-O2`	Constant folding, dead code elimination
`-O3`	Constant folding, dead code elimination, inlining

27.5 Debug Info

```
./sage -g program.sage     # Include debug information
```

Chapter 28

Bare-Metal and OS Development

Sage can compile to bare-metal targets for OS and embedded development.

28.1 Bare-Metal Compilation

```
# Compile to bare-metal ELF (no libc, no OS dependencies)
./sage --compile-bare kernel.sage -o kernel.elf --target x86-64

# Compile to UEFI PE application
./sage --compile-uefi boot.sage -o boot.efi
```

28.2 Target Architectures

Target	Flag	Description
x86-64	`--target x86-64`	AMD64 / Intel 64
aarch64	`--target aarch64`	ARM 64-bit
rv64	`--target rv64`	RISC-V 64-bit

28.3 Boot and Kernel Libraries

Sage includes libraries for OS development:

```
import os.boot.multiboot as mb
import os.boot.gdt as gdt

# Generate Multiboot2 header
let header = mb.create_header()

# Generate GDT (Global Descriptor Table)
let gdt_table = gdt.build_gdt64()
```

28.4 QEMU Integration

```
# Run kernel in QEMU (x86_64)
make qemu-bare

# Run kernel in QEMU (aarch64)
make qemu-bare-arm64

# Debug with GDB
make qemu-debug
# In another terminal:
gdb -ex 'target remote :1234' kernel.elf
```

Sage includes QEMU VM configuration libraries for creating and managing virtual machines for testing bare-metal and kernel code. Kernel console, physical/virtual memory management, filesystem (ext2/4, FAT, Btrfs), and device tree libraries are available for full OS development.

Chapter 29

Part VI: Tooling

Chapter 30

Developer Tools

30.1 REPL

Launch the interactive read-eval-print loop:

```
./sage
# or
./sage --repl
```

```
sage> 2 + 3
5
sage> let x = "hello"
sage> print upper(x)
HELLO
sage> proc square(n): return n * n end
sage> print square(7)
49
sage> :quit
```

The REPL supports multiline input, error recovery, and all language features.

30.2 Formatter

Automatically format Sage source files:

```
./sage --fmt program.sage
# or
./sage fmt program.sage
```

The formatter normalizes indentation, spacing, and code layout. Both C and self-hosted (Sage) implementations are available.

30.3 Linter

Check code for style issues and common mistakes:

```
./sage --lint program.sage
# or
./sage lint program.sage
```

The linter reports unused variables, naming convention violations, overly complex functions, and other code quality issues.

30.4 Type Checker

Run static type analysis:

```
./sage check program.sage
```

The type checker performs best-effort type inference and reports type mismatches, unreachable code, and annotation violations.

30.5 Safety Analyzer

Run the compile-time safety analysis:

```
./sage safety program.sage
./sage --strict-safety program.sage
```

Reports ownership violations, borrow conflicts, lifetime errors, and nil-safety issues.

30.6 Language Server (LSP)

Start the LSP server for editor integration:

```
./sage --lsp
# or
./sage-lsp
```

The LSP server provides:

- **Autocompletion** of functions, variables, and module members
- **Diagnostics** (errors and warnings as you type)
- **Hover info** (type information and documentation)
- **Go-to-definition** navigation

Both C and self-hosted implementations exist. Compatible with VS Code, Neovim, and any editor supporting the Language Server Protocol.

Chapter 31

Build System

31.1 Makefile Targets

```
make                    # Build the sage interpreter
make test               # Run interpreter tests (269+ tests)
make test-selfhost      # Run self-hosted tests (1567+ tests)
make test-all           # Run all tests

# Bare-metal / QEMU
make qemu-bare          # Run kernel in QEMU (x86_64)
make qemu-bare-arm64    # Run kernel in QEMU (aarch64)
make qemu-debug         # Debug kernel with GDB
make kernel-bare        # Compile bare-metal kernel
make kernel-uefi        # Compile UEFI application
```

31.2 Version

The version is stored in a single `VERSION` file at the repository root. All build systems (Makefile, CMakeLists.txt, build.sh, sagemake) read from this file automatically. Current version: **2.1.0**.

Chapter 32

Part VII: Appendices

Chapter 33

Appendix A: Built-in Functions

The following functions are available globally without any imports.

33.1 Core Functions

Function	Description
`print(value)`	Print value to stdout with newline
`input(prompt)`	Read a line from stdin
`len(x)`	Length of string, array, dict, or tuple
`type(x)`	Type name as string
`str(x)`	Convert any value to string
`tonumber(s)`	Parse string to number
`int(x)`	Truncate number to integer
`chr(n)`	Integer code point to character
`ord(c)`	Character to integer code point
`clock()`	CPU time in seconds (high resolution)
`hash(x)`	Hash value of a string
`doc(f)`	Get doc comment for a function

33.2 Array Functions

Function	Description
`push(arr, val)`	Append value to end of array
`append(arr, val)`	Alias for `push`
`pop(arr)`	Remove and return last element
`range(n)`	Array `[0, 1, ..., n-1]`
`range(a, b)`	Array `[a, a+1, ..., b-1]`
`slice(arr, start, end)`	Sub-array from start to end
`array_extend(a, b)`	Extend array a with elements of b

33.3 String Functions

Function	Description
`split(str, delim)`	Split string by delimiter
`join(arr, delim)`	Join array elements with delimiter
`replace(str, old, new)`	Replace all occurrences
`upper(str)`	Convert to uppercase
`lower(str)`	Convert to lowercase
`strip(str)`	Trim leading/trailing whitespace
`startswith(str, prefix)`	Check if string starts with prefix
`endswith(str, suffix)`	Check if string ends with suffix
`contains(str, sub)`	Check if string contains substring
`indexof(str, sub)`	Find index of substring (-1 if not found)

33.4 Dictionary Functions

Function	Description
`dict_keys(d)`	Array of all keys
`dict_values(d)`	Array of all values
`dict_has(d, key)`	Check if key exists
`dict_delete(d, key)`	Remove key from dictionary

33.5 Generator Functions

Function	Description
`next(gen)`	Advance generator and return next value

33.6 GC Functions

Function	Description
`gc_collect()`	Force a garbage collection cycle
`gc_stats()`	Return GC statistics as a dict
`gc_collections()`	Return number of GC cycles performed
`gc_enable()`	Enable the garbage collector
`gc_disable()`	Disable the garbage collector

33.7 Path Functions

Function	Description
`path_join(a, b)`	Join two path components
`path_dirname(path)`	Directory portion of path
`path_basename(path)`	Filename portion of path
`path_ext(path)`	File extension
`path_exists(path)`	Check if path exists
`path_is_dir(path)`	Check if path is a directory
`path_is_file(path)`	Check if path is a regular file

33.8 Bytes Functions

Function	Description
`bytes(n)`	Create byte buffer of size n
`bytes_len(b)`	Length of byte buffer
`bytes_get(b, i)`	Get byte at index
`bytes_set(b, i, v)`	Set byte at index
`bytes_to_string(b)`	Convert bytes to string
`bytes_slice(b, start, end)`	Slice byte buffer
`bytes_push(b, v)`	Append byte to buffer

33.9 Memory Functions

Function	Description
`mem_alloc(size)`	Allocate raw memory
`mem_free(ptr)`	Free allocated memory
`mem_read(ptr, off)`	Read value at pointer offset
`mem_write(ptr, off, val)`	Write value at pointer offset
`mem_size(ptr)`	Size of allocation
`addressof(val)`	Get memory address of a value
`sizeof(type)`	Size of a type in bytes
`ptr_add(ptr, off)`	Pointer arithmetic
`ptr_to_int(ptr)`	Convert pointer to integer

33.10 FFI Functions

Function	Description
`ffi_open(lib_path)`	Open shared library
`ffi_close(handle)`	Close shared library
`ffi_sym(handle, name)`	Look up symbol
`ffi_call(sym, args, ret_type)`	Call foreign function

33.11 Struct Interop Functions

Function	Description
`struct_def(fields)`	Define a C struct layout
`struct_new(def)`	Allocate a new struct
`struct_get(ptr, def, field)`	Read struct field
`struct_set(ptr, def, field, val)`	Write struct field
`struct_size(def)`	Size of struct in bytes

33.12 Assembly Functions

Function	Description
`asm_exec(code)`	Execute inline assembly
`asm_compile(code)`	Compile assembly to machine code
`asm_arch()`	Get current architecture string

Chapter 34

Appendix B: CLI Reference

```
Usage: sage [options] [file.sage]

Running:
  (no args)              Interactive REPL
  file.sage              Run script in interpreter
  --repl                 Interactive REPL (explicit)

Compilation:
  --emit-c FILE -o OUT   Emit C source code
  --compile FILE -o OUT  Compile to binary via C backend
  --emit-llvm FILE -o OUT  Emit LLVM IR text
  --compile-llvm FILE -o OUT  Compile to binary via LLVM (requires clang)
  --emit-asm FILE -o OUT  Emit assembly source
  --compile-native FILE -o OUT  Compile to native binary
  --compile-bare FILE -o OUT  Bare-metal ELF (no libc)
  --compile-uefi FILE -o OUT  UEFI PE application
  --target ARCH          Target architecture: x86-64, aarch64, rv64

Optimization:
  -O0                    No optimization
  -O1                    Constant folding
  -O2                    Constant folding + dead code elimination
  -O3                    Aggressive (+ inlining)
  -g                     Include debug info

Safety:
  --safety               Check @safe annotated functions
  --strict-safety        Enforce safety globally

Tooling:
  --fmt FILE             Format source code
  --lint FILE            Lint source code
  --lsp                  Start Language Server Protocol server
```

```
  fmt FILE               Format source code
  lint FILE              Lint source code
  check FILE             Run type checker
  safety FILE            Run safety analyzer

Self-Hosted Compiler:
  sage.sage FILE         Run file in self-hosted interpreter
  sage.sage --emit-c FILE  Emit C via self-hosted compiler
  sage.sage --emit-llvm FILE  Emit LLVM IR via self-hosted compiler
  sage.sage --emit-asm FILE  Emit assembly via self-hosted compiler
  sage.sage fmt FILE     Format via self-hosted formatter
  sage.sage lint FILE    Lint via self-hosted linter
  sage.sage check FILE   Type check via self-hosted checker
```

Chapter 35

Appendix C: Language Gotchas

This section documents known behaviors and design decisions. Items marked **FIXED** were resolved in v1.4 or later.

35.1 Still Relevant

1. **`0` is truthy** – Only `false` and `nil` are falsy. This is an intentional design decision. Use explicit comparisons: `if x == 0:` not `if not x:`.
2. **`chr(0)` truncates strings** – Null bytes terminate C strings in the interpreter. The runtime uses C-style null-terminated strings, so inserting `chr(0)` into a string will truncate it at that point.
3. **No wildcard imports** – `from module import *` is not supported. Use `import module` then `module.func()`, or import specific names: `from module import func`.
4. **No multiline dict/array literals** – Build complex structures incrementally with assignments:

```
let config = {}
config["host"] = "localhost"
config["port"] = 8080
```

5. **`match` and `init` are reserved keywords** – `match` cannot be used as a variable name. `init` is reserved but works as a property name after `.` and `->`.
6. **`super` requires explicit `self`** – Write `super.init(self, args)` not `super.init(args)`.

35.2 Fixed in v1.4+

7. ~~No escape sequences~~ – **FIXED.** `\n`, `\t`, `\r`, `\\`, `\"`, `\xHH` and other escape sequences now work in string literals.
8. ~~No hex literals~~ – **FIXED.** `0xFF` and `0o755` are now parsed correctly as number literals.
9. ~~elif chains malfunction~~ – **FIXED.** Unlimited `elif` branches are now supported without issues.

10. ~~**Instance == always false**~~ – **FIXED.** Structural equality now works for class instances, arrays, and dicts.
11. ~~**push/append mismatch**~~ – **FIXED.** Both `push()` and `append()` work identically in the C interpreter. They are aliases for the same native function.
12. ~~**% casts to int**~~ – **FIXED.** The modulo operator now uses `fmod()` and preserves float semantics. `3.7 % 1` returns `0.7`, not `0`.
13. ~~**Class methods can't see module-level vars**~~ – **FIXED.** Methods now have access to their defining environment via `defining_env`.

Chapter 36

Appendix D: Reserved Keywords

Sage reserves the following 54 keywords. They cannot be used as variable or function names.

36.1 Control Flow

Keyword	Purpose
`if`	Conditional branch
`elif`	Else-if branch
`else`	Default branch
`while`	While loop
`for`	For-in loop
`in`	For-in iteration
`break`	Exit loop
`continue`	Skip to next iteration
`match`	Pattern matching
`case`	Match case
`default`	Match default
`end`	Block terminator

36.2 Functions and Classes

Keyword	Purpose
`proc`	Function definition
`return`	Return from function
`class`	Class definition
`self`	Instance reference
`init`	Constructor method
`super`	Parent class reference
`struct`	Struct definition
`enum`	Enum definition
`trait`	Trait definition

36.3 Variables

Keyword	Purpose
`let`	Immutable binding
`var`	Mutable variable

36.4 Values and Logic

Keyword	Purpose
`true`	Boolean true
`false`	Boolean false
`nil`	Null value
`and`	Logical AND
`or`	Logical OR
`not`	Logical NOT

36.5 Exceptions

Keyword	Purpose
`try`	Begin exception block
`catch`	Handle exception
`finally`	Always-execute block
`raise`	Throw exception

36.6 Advanced

Keyword	Purpose
`defer`	Deferred execution
`yield`	Generator yield
`async`	Async function
`await`	Await async result
`import`	Import module
`from`	From-import
`as`	Import alias
`unsafe`	Unsafe block
`print`	Print statement

Note: `elif` is recognized by the lexer as a combination of `else` + `if` tokens but is effectively reserved. The `end` keyword is used to terminate all block constructs: `proc`, `if`, `while`, `for`, `match`, `case`, `try`, `catch`, `finally`, `class`, `struct`, `enum`, `trait`, and `unsafe`.